Windows: First-Time Installation on a PC or Laptop

Step 1: Check System Requirements

Before installing Windows, ensure your PC meets the minimum requirements:

- 64-bit processor (1 GHz or faster)
- 4 GB RAM or more
- 64 GB storage or more
- UEFI firmware with Secure Boot
- TPM 2.0 (for Windows 11)
- Internet connection (recommended)

Step 2: Create a Bootable USB Drive

1. Download the Windows ISO or Media Creation Tool from Microsoft's official website.
2. Insert a USB drive (8 GB or larger).
3. Use the Media Creation Tool or Rufus to create a bootable USB.

Step 3: Boot from the USB Drive

1. Insert the bootable USB into the computer.
2. Restart the PC.
3. Press the boot menu key (F12, F9, Esc, or Del, depending on the manufacturer).
4. Select the USB drive and press **Enter**.

Step 4: Start Windows Setup

1. Choose your:
    - Language
    - Time and currency format
    - Keyboard layout
2. Click **Next**.
3. Click **Install Now**.

Step 5: Enter Product Key

- Enter your Windows product key, or
- Select **I don't have a product key** to activate Windows later.

Step 6: Select Windows Edition

Choose the edition that matches your license (Home, Pro, etc.), then click **Next**.

Step 7: Accept the License Agreement

- Check **I accept the Microsoft Software License Terms**.
- Click **Next**.

Step 8: Choose Installation Type

Select **Custom: Install Windows only (Advanced)** for a clean installation.

Step 9: Select the Installation Drive

1. Select the drive where Windows will be installed.
2. If installing on a new or empty drive, select the unallocated space and click **Next**.
3. If necessary, delete old partitions (this erases all data).

Step 10: Install Windows

Windows will:

- Copy files
- Install features
- Install updates
- Restart the computer several times

Step 11: Complete Initial Setup

After installation:

- Select your country and keyboard layout.
- Connect to Wi-Fi.
- Sign in with a Microsoft account or create a local account.

- Set a PIN.
- Choose your privacy settings.

Step 12: Install Drivers and Updates

1. Open **Settings > Windows Update**.
2. Install all available updates.
3. Install device drivers if required (graphics, audio, Wi-Fi, etc.).

Step 13: Install Essential Software

Install commonly used applications such as:

- Web browser
- Microsoft Office
- Antivirus (if needed)
- PDF reader
- Media player

Your Windows installation is now complete and ready to use.